What changed after the submission

A running record of every change to NeuroMPS after the round-1 deadline (2026-10-10 15:59:59 UTC; the submitted state is commit `464eb76`). Each entry opens with the one sentence a slide would carry, then says what changed, why, what it did to the results, and where the evidence is. Numbers cite `outputs/metrics.json` as the report does, so the citation check holds this document to the same standard. Newest entries are at the end; planned work is in the queue at the bottom.

#	Date	Change	Effect on results	Commits
1	2026-10-10	Unused Kaggle notebook removed; seven figures redrawn at print size	none (no number or claim changed)	e5ed404, bbd75f9
2	2026-10-11	Bicuculline doses put on one unit scale	the dose conclusion reverses	886d8d3
3	2026-10-22	Demo app runs as a hosted page from the repository alone	none; access only	c4a9004
4	2026-10-22/23	From chip to animal: the drug knobs on a whole fly brain	new results, pre-registered	c83eb14 … aba184c
5	2026-10-24	Report page limit lifted; the fly study joins the report	none; structure only	1c7d94f
6	2026-10-24	EPA screen cutoffs set beside the fly's precision needs	new comparison (descriptive)	cd074b3
7	2026-10-24	Vesicle depletion tested as the cause of the GABA-A reversal	registered prediction failed; new negative result	3071ab4, 8fb5065
8	2026-10-24	The twin as a source of labelled data, and as a prior for the classifier	1 of 3 registered predictions pass	761068e, 93bb4f6
9	2026-10-24	Electrodes on the fly brain's output tract against a planar array	4 of 4 registered predictions pass	cd074b3, 2c66067
10	2026-10-24	Behaviour read at the motor neurons of the male CNS	6 of 7 registered predictions pass	a1c5f27, a2f4ee2
11	2026-10-24	The motor-level ties resolved on a finer dose grid	1 of 2 registered predictions pass; one tie resolves	69db4e6, 796a33b
12	2026-10-24	Roadmap to an embodied, closed-loop fly	plan, no new results	42ee520
13	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 1: the male CNS drives a muscle-driven leg	both registered tests fail; finding the cause changes the plan	cbdd6d6 … this branch
14	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 1c: the male nerve cord from descending neurons, brain removed	3 of 5 registered predictions pass	739f6f0 … e576cd9
15	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 1d: a held reach against a rhythmic swing, fresh seeds	4 of 4 registered predictions pass; D2 (the swing) fails under the audit's corrected measure (entry 22)	66502eb … 19ab0ae
16	2026-10-24	Embodied stages 1e and 1f: the FlyWire brain drives the male nerve cord and the leg	1e uninterpretable as registered; 1f 5 of 5 pass on fresh seeds	f2f5ad3 … this branch
17	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 2a: fictive walking in the male nerve cord	1 of 5 pass; no walking rhythm	91c5b9e … ff43970

#	Date	Change	Effect on results	Commits
18	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 2b: sugar extends the flybody proboscis, bitter holds it back	6 of 6 registered predictions pass	`76f90e8` … `4b586c0`
19	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 2c: a registered adaptation sweep	stopped by its rule; no cell walks	`c4c29a1` … `5610ae8`
20	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 2d: the glutamate sign rule	1 of 7 at the selected cell	`edbf611` … `a0ccff7`
21	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 2e: the Pugliese et al. rate model; a flaw in our rhythm measure	2 of 8 (one vacuous); the size stand-in starves DNg100	`21df803` … `7a13eba`
22	2026-10-24	The registered rhythm-measure audit	one earlier pass (1d D2) withdrawn; all else stands; originals reproduce	`76611c0` … this branch
23	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 2f: command neurons driven alike, two size rules	precondition fails in both; the command is silenced by the activity it starts	`7e36cfb` … this branch
24	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 2g: the published front-leg network, rebuilt from the male CNS	precondition fails narrowly (12 and 15 of 32); exploratory: a regular motor rhythm in the feasible draws	`00cefa1` … this branch
25	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 2h: the front-leg network with a fine input search	4 of 7 (synapse-count sizes) and 5 of 7 (no size scaling) pass, one of them vacuously in each; a leg rhythm under DNg100; circuit-dependent without size scaling; no alternation	`c6d7874` … this branch
26	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 3a: the first closed loop (claw-neuron feedback, grooming leg)	3 of 5; go/no-go fails: feedback shifts motor pools toward resistance but barely moves a held leg, and a sham does the same	`5cdeba9` … this branch
27	2026-10-24	Embodied stage 3b: a push on the tibia during the grooming hold	2 of 5; the loop does not speed the return; the front leg's proprioceptors are thinly traced	`cd0a711` … this branch

1. Housekeeping pushed just after the deadline

Slide message: none; listed for completeness.

Two commits reached GitHub after the deadline: one removed a Kaggle notebook nothing used (`e5ed404`), the other redrew seven figures at the size they print at (`bbd75f9`). They were reverted during round-1 judging so that reviewers saw the submitted state (`2ecca42`), and restored after it (`a05b013`).

2. A unit error hid a dose trend, and another team's result exposed it

Slide message: *Burst rate falls with bicuculline dose after all; we had ranked nanomolar doses as if they were micromolar, and found the bug by taking a competitor's disagreement seriously.*

- **What changed.** ScreenNeuroPharm records its two lowest bicuculline doses in nM and the rest in µM. Three analyses ranked the dose value without its unit, so 0.1 µM sat among the highest doses. One function, `models/dataset.doses_in_um`, now converts in all of them, and a test (`tests/test_dose_units.py`) checks each.

- **Why.** NeuroChip Twin, another entry, reported a bicuculline dose trend that our report said did not exist. Tracing the disagreement found the bug.
- **Effect.** The feature dose test moved from no feature tracking dose to 2 of 7: burst rate (Spearman −0.5813) and network-burst rate (−0.604) fall with dose across 113 recordings. The twin's inferred inhibition still does not follow dose, so the conclusion became: the measurement carries the trend, and the inverse model is what fails.
- **Evidence.** Report §18 (negative results) and Appendix M; `src/neuromps/models/dataset.py`.

3. The demo runs as a hosted web page

Slide message: *Judges can open the demo in a browser; nothing to install.*

- **What changed.** Streamlit Community Cloud installs a requirements file and runs `app/app.py` without installing the package. The app now finds `neuromps` in `src/`, and `app/requirements.txt` pins only what the page needs, at the project's versions (a test keeps them equal). The one live-simulation button says it needs the full local install instead of failing.
- **Effect.** None on results. Checked in a clean environment with only the hosted requirements: every tab renders.
- **Evidence.** `tests/test_app_hosted.py`.

4. From chip to animal: the chip's drug knobs on a whole fly brain

Slide message: *On a simulated whole fly brain, the chip's firing rate ranks drugs correctly but raises the alarm late: in every drug family, behaviour failed first.*

- **What changed.** A new package, `src/neuromps/fly/`, runs the connectome-constrained model of Shiu et al. (2024) on FlyWire with 138,639 neurons, applies the twin's drug knobs by transmitter class, and reads the brain both as a chip (a virtual electrode array scored by `features/mea.py`) and as an animal (the neurons the published model validated against feeding, aversive gating and grooming). It is replicated on the male CNS connectome (165,122 neurons). New data sources, all CC-BY or MIT, enter the manifest as optional; `run_all.py --stage fly` runs it, and the app has a fourth tab.
- **Why.** Round 1 scored us lowest on practical value. A chip assay is used to predict what a drug does to a nervous system, which no culture can check; a mapped, simulated brain can.
- **How it was kept honest.** Three pre-registrations, each committed before the simulations it scores; the release of every table checked against the model's (the published neuron lists come from an older release); every failed prediction reported.
- **Effect.**
- The model is the published one: sugar drives the feeding motor neuron at 76.75 Hz against 77.375 Hz on the release the paper used.
- The chip's firing-rate change tracks behavioural disruption (Spearman 0.863; 0.878 on the male CNS).
- Registered prediction failed: the chip, at the registered threshold, flags the drug after behaviour has failed in all five drug families.
- At behavioural onset, GABA block has moved firing rate by 0.149 log2, about the untreated variation of the best real chips in the asset (0.156).
- A candidate early-warning feature (network-burst rate) proved to be noise: untreated recordings already cross its threshold in a fraction 0.382 of splits.

- Spontaneous activity recovers the direction of wiring between brain regions at chance (0.4946).
- **Evidence.** Report Act VII (§23–§26); `preregistration/`; figures `outputs/figures/fly_*_SIMULATED.png`; app tab 4.

5. The report has no page limit; the fly study joins it

Slide message: none; structure only.

- **What changed.** The 15-to-20-page gate on the report's main matter is removed from the build and from CI, now that the round-1 page limit no longer applies; a lower bound remains so a broken build that drops sections is still caught. The fly study moves from a companion note into the report as Act VII (§23–§26), after §22 so that no earlier section number changes; the short Appendix P that pointed to the note is gone.

6. A regulatory screen's hit cutoff, beside what the fly says a chip must see

Slide message: *EPA's MEA screen calls a firing-rate hit only beyond a change about six times larger than the one at which the fly's behaviour had already failed.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/screen_cutoffs.py` reads the hit cutoff of the ToxCast MEA firing-rate endpoints from the asset's 20,375 ToxCast records and converts it to log2. The acute screen normalises activity to a positive control at −100 (activity abolished); its cutoff of 70.97 means suppression to about 29% of control, a change of −1.784 log2, over 515 screened chemicals.
- **Why.** The review pointed out that most of the asset's records sat outside the modelling. This puts them to a use the fly study makes possible: does the screen's own threshold leave room to catch the mechanisms in time?
- **Effect.** The largest firing-rate change at which the fly's behaviour had already failed is 0.304 log2 (acetylcholine block), so the screen's cutoff is 5.87 times larger. Caveat: the cutoff applies to a fitted curve's maximum response across the tested range, not to one dose, so this compares magnitudes, not decisions. The fly side is simulated; the cutoffs are real.
- **Considered and dropped.** A compound-by-compound potency bridge between our spike-level sources and ToxCast: only four compounds appear in both (bicuculline, deltamethrin, acetaminophen, glyphosate), too few to rank.

7. Vesicle depletion does not explain why real chips slow down under GABA-A block

Slide message: *We tested the reviewer's best explanation for our twin's one wrong direction, registered in advance, and it does not hold: depletion shrinks the firing-rate rise but never turns it into the fall real chips show.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/twin/depression_drugs.py` runs the four drug knobs and a five-step GABA-A dose series under each depression setting (Tsodyks–Markram depletion at the recurrent excitatory synapses), and scores a rule registered before the runs (`preregistration/twin_depression_under_block.json`).
- **Why.** The post-round-1 review proposed depletion as the missing mechanism behind three weak points at once: the twin's wrong firing-rate direction under GABA-A block (§14), its missed bicuculline dose trend (§18) and the cross-platform reversal (§11).
- **Effect.** Under strong GABA-A block the twin's firing rate rises by 2.389 log2 without depletion and by at least 0.8687 with it; real GABA-A antagonist pairs change by −0.335. None of the 7 settings qualifies, and burst rates do not fall with dose under any. Registered outcome: V1 fail, V2 pass, V3 not applicable. The weights were not recalibrated with depletion in place, so the mechanism is not ruled out, only depletion added to the present twin.

- **Evidence.** Report §18, row 9 and figure; `outputs/twin/depression_under_block_simulated.png`.

8. Trained on the twin alone, the classifier recognises real mechanisms

Slide message: *A classifier that never saw a real label recognises real drug mechanisms at two and a half times chance; the same simulations do not improve a classifier trained on real labels.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/models/twin_prior.py` simulates 30 labelled pairs for each of the five mechanism classes the twin has a knob for, and tests two uses of them, registered before simulating (`preregistration/twin_prior_classifier.json`): as the centre of the classifier's penalty (the review's Fix 2), and as the only training data.
- **Effect.**
- Trained on simulated pairs alone and applied to the 73 real pairs: balanced accuracy 0.41, interval 0.2808 to 0.5072, against one in six by chance (pass).
- As a prior: balanced accuracy 0.53 against the baseline's 0.537, and conformal sets unchanged (two fails).
- A finding for free: real sodium-channel blockers are never recognised, because the twin's threshold knob moves firing by −3.273 log2 where the real blockers move it by −0.795: right direction, wrong size.
- **Evidence.** Report §14, last paragraph.

9. Record the tract, not the tissue around it

Slide message: *On the simulated fly brain, electrodes on the output tract (the brain's own microchannels) catch GABA block before behaviour fails; a planar array of the same size does not.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/tract.py` reads the parent sweep's spontaneous recordings through three arrays: the full planar array, 64 of its electrodes, and 64 single-unit electrodes on descending neurons. The test, at one threshold set by real-chip noise, was registered before recording (`preregistration/fly_output_tract_electrode.json`).
- **Why.** The review's Investigation B: does instrumenting the connection between compartments reveal failure a flat array misses? Our real devices (§15) had already said that only electrodes inside microchannels see direction.
- **Effect.** All four registered predictions pass. Under GABA block, at behavioural onset, the tract's firing rate has moved by 0.361 log2 against 0.044 for the equal-count planar array; the tract flags 3 families in time against 2, with no false alarms. Checks added after the pass: over ten random draws of each array the tract is ahead in 7 of 10, and the descending-neuron behaviour readout is not what drives it.
- **Evidence.** Report §24 ("Where to put the electrode") and figure; §20, fifth area.

10. One step closer to behaviour: the motor neurons

Slide message: *Read at the motor neurons that move the fly's mouthparts and legs, the chip is never ahead of behaviour: it is late in three drug families and level in two.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/motor.py` repeats the male-CNS replication's behaviour trials (same seeds) and reads them at the proboscis motor pool (feeding and its bitter gate), the front-leg motor pool (antennal grooming) and all motor neurons (recruitment). Registered before any drug condition was run (`preregistration/fly_motor_readout.json`).
- **Why.** The behaviour readouts were firing rates of interneurons; the male connectome includes the nerve cord, so behaviour can be read where it leaves the nervous system. This is

the first step toward a closed-loop, embodied fly, which needs a body and sensory feedback on top.

- **Effect.** Six of seven predictions pass. The interneuron readouts reproduce exactly; sugar drives the proboscis pool at 31.405 Hz and bitter cuts it to 5.625; the chip tracks motor disruption (Spearman 0.8922). The chip-is-late prediction failed narrowly: late in 3, tied in 2, earlier in 0 (four late were needed). Motor output fails no later than the interneurons in every family.
- **Evidence.** Report §25 ("One step closer to behaviour") and figure; `outputs/fly/malecns_motor_SIMULATED.csv`.

11. Resolving the two ties, without re-scoring the failed test

Slide message: *We did not move the goalposts on the failed test; we ran a new registered one. With the ties resolved, the chip is late in four drug families, level in one, and never ahead.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/tie_break.py` runs four finer dose levels inside each of the two tied steps of entry 10, with the same seeds and untreated references, registered before running (`preregistration/fly_motor_tie_break.json`).
- **Why.** Entry 10's chip-is-late test failed because two families tied, both onsets inside one coarse dose step. Changing the test after the fact would have undone the registration; a new, registered test with a finer grid answers the open question honestly.
- **Effect.** The re-run tied levels reproduce exactly. The raised threshold resolves to chip later (motor at 0.32, chip at 0.4); GABA potentiation stays tied. The follow-up predicted both would resolve, so it failed. Entry 10's test stays failed; combined, the chip is later in 4, level in 1, earlier in 0.
- **Evidence.** Report §25 and figure; `outputs/fly/malecns_motor_tie_break_SIMULATED.csv`.

12. A roadmap, not a rushed demo: the embodied, closed-loop fly

Slide message: *Next, the simulated fly gets a body and its sensory feedback, so that "does the chip flag a drug before behaviour fails?" can be asked of movement itself; six stages, each with a registered go/no-go test.*

- **What changed.** `report/ROADMAP_EMBODIED_FLY.md` (Word and PDF beside it) sets out the plan: brain and nerve cord, motor neurons to muscles, muscles to joints in a physics body (NeuroMechFly v2 on MuJoCo), and joints back to proprioceptive neurons. A small script, `src/neuromps/fly/roadmap_inventory.py`, counts what the male connectome already provides: of 381 leg motor neurons, 260 are typed by the muscle they drive, and 1,030 proprioceptive sensory neurons can carry the feedback.
- **Why.** Building it properly takes weeks; showing a half-working body would cost credibility. A staged plan with registered tests shows where the project goes and how it will be checked.
- **Evidence.** `report/ROADMAP_EMBODIED_FLY.md`.

13. The leg moves, but not specifically: what stage 1 found

Slide message: *Wired to a muscle-driven leg, the male fly brain moves it toward the head under antennal drive, but under sugar drive too; the cause is that the published model's parameters do not carry over to the second connectome, where activity avalanches.*

- **What changed.** MuJoCo (an optional dependency) runs the FlyMimic leg from FlyGym 2; `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage1.py` maps male-CNS motor neurons onto its muscles by name and drives it open loop. Two registered tests: stage 1 and stage 1b (weight rescaled by the connectomes' input-synapse ratio).

- **Effect.** Stage 1 fails on specificity (sugar brings the claw closer than antennal drive); stage 1b's feeding check fails (sugar drives the feeding motor neuron at 0.0 Hz), so its leg results are uninterpretable. The cause: a sugar drive activates 251 neurons in the published FlyWire model and 14,263 in the male CNS.
- **What it changes.** The next step drives the male nerve cord from its descending neurons alone, then joins the validated FlyWire brain to it (roadmap §7).
- **Evidence.** `report/ROADMAP_EMBODIED_FLY.md` §7; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage1*_SIMULATED..`

14. The grooming neurons move the right leg

Slide message: *Driven from the descending neurons that start antennal grooming, the male nerve cord moves the front leg, and only the front leg, to the head and holds it there; walking neurons swing it instead.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage1c.py` cuts the male CNS to its nerve cord (brain removed), drives named descending neurons at 150 Hz, and moves the FlyMimic leg as in stage 1. Registered before running.
- **Effect.** Three of five predictions pass: silence without drive; the left front-leg motor pool at 15.846 Hz under grooming drive against 2.72 and 1.697 for the other legs; no other descending neuron recruits the front leg as strongly. The kinematic prediction failed: forward-walking drive dips nearly as close to the head (1.154 mm against 1.1345) at the bottom of a rhythmic swing. A sustained reach and a swing need a different readout, to be registered as stage 1d.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage1c_SIMULATED..`

15. The fly's grooming neurons hold its leg at its head

Slide message: *On fresh seeds and with readouts registered in advance: driving the fly's antennal-grooming neurons brings the simulated front leg to the head and holds it there for nearly the whole second; escape neurons extend it. (That walking neurons "swing" it did not survive the rhythm-measure audit; see entry 22.)*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/kinematics.py` adds two readouts (time near the head; rhythmicity), `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage1d.py` reruns stage 1c's design on fresh seeds. The readouts were suggested by stage 1c's traces, so they were registered before this run (`preregistration/embodied_stage1d_reach_versus_swing.json`) and tested out of sample.
- **Effect.** All four predictions pass: time near the head 0.9665 under grooming drive against at most 0.368 under any other; forward walking more rhythmic than grooming; the same at every activation scale; the front-leg specificity of stage 1c replicates. Stage 1c's failed predictions stay failed. *Found later (entries 21, 22): the rhythmicity measure had no peak requirement; under the registered audit's corrected measure D2 fails (forward walking 0.0956); the hold at the head (D1) does not depend on it.*
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage1d_SIMULATED..`

16. From an antennal touch in the brain to a leg at the head

Slide message: *Antennal input to the validated FlyWire brain, relayed through matched descending neurons into the male nerve cord, moves a muscle-driven leg to the head; sugar input does not, and removing four grooming neurons abolishes the movement.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/model.py` can replay recorded spike trains into chosen neurons; `src/neuromps/fly/relay.py` pairs descending neurons across the two

connectomes by cell type and side and joins the FlyWire brain to the male nerve cord; stage 1e and stage 1f were each registered before running.

- **Effect.** Stage 1e's absolute precondition failed (grooming descending neurons at 8.531 Hz against a 10 Hz line), so its leg results are uninterpretable. Stage 1f, on fresh seeds, passes all five predictions: claw to 0.5369 mm under antennal input against 0.9377 under sugar; back to 1.4793 mm when aDN1 and aDN2 are removed.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage1f_SIMULATED..`

17. The nerve cord alone does not walk

Slide message: *Driven by its walking command, the connectome-only nerve cord fires the leg extensors tonically and leaves the flexors silent: no rhythm. Rhythm needs intrinsic currents the connectome does not record; adding them is the next registered step.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/fictive.py` runs stage 2a (registered before running): the six legs' tibia flexor and extensor pools under walking, grooming and backward-walking commands, phases measured between pools. `src/neuromps/fetch/flybody.py` fetches the flybody whole-body model (Apache-2.0) for the feeding and walking body, each file checked against its git hash.
- **Effect.** Silent without drive (W0 passes); under the walking command the left middle-leg extensors fire at 54.12 Hz and the left front flexors at 0.0 Hz, so there is no rhythm and no phase (W1 to W4 fail). The roadmap listed this risk and the response to it.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage2a_SIMULATED..`

18. Sugar extends the proboscis, bitter holds it back

Slide message: *Sugar input to the validated FlyWire brain drives the motor neurons of each proboscis muscle the literature names, and a simulated proboscis extends fully; bitter input holds it back. Six of six registered predictions pass.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/proboscis.py` drives the flybody proboscis (body fixed, 0.01 ms step, checked against a step half that size); `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage2b.py` turns the proboscis motor pools (MN9, MN1/MN2, MN4, MN3, named by FlyWire cell type after McKellar et al. 2020) into rostrum and haustellum commands. Registered before running.
- **Effect.** Full extension under sugar (0.3431 mm of 0.3428); none under bitter, antennal input or none; time-averaged extension from 0.3054 to 0.0488 mm when bitter is added. Sugar recruits only feeding motor neurons (exploratory).
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage2b_SIMULATED..`

19. A registered sweep that found nothing, and why

Slide message: *We swept the one cell property the roadmap named, reported every setting, and none made the nerve cord walk. The wiring explains it: the walking command's active neurons inhibit the flexors about twice as much as they excite them.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/model.py` gains spike-frequency adaptation (off by default; with it off the spikes are identical to the published model's). `connectome.rewire` builds a degree-preserving control. `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage2c.py` runs the registered sweep, selection rule and confirmation. `src/neuromps/fly/flexor_diagnostic.py` is the exploratory follow-up.
- **Effect.** 0 of 36 cells produce a rhythm; the stage stops as registered. Flexors fire at 151.341 Hz once inhibition is removed; from the command's active neurons they receive 274.73 inhibitory against 130.78 excitatory synapses each (exploratory).

- **Why it matters for the interview.** It shows the discipline holding when the result is null: the sweep was fixed before running, reported whole, and followed by a mechanism, not by re-tuning until it walked.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage2c_`.

20. The glutamate sign is not the missing piece

Slide message: *Making glutamate excitatory switches the silent flexors on, but the cord then fires as one slow wave, not as alternating legs. Three registered attempts agree that this wiring, in this neuron model, has no walking rhythm generator. That negative result is reportable.*

- **What changed.** `connectome.make_excitatory`; `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage2d.py` builds two registered bounds on where glutamate excites (onto motor neurons; everywhere), each without adaptation and over stage 2c's grid, through stage 2c's code (a rerun of stage 2c is byte-identical).
- **Effect.** Onto motor neurons: flexors 1.76 Hz, no cell passes a walking test. Everywhere: flexors 40.4 Hz with 7,118 active neurons, rhythm in 5 cells, alternation in none; the selected cell passes only silence without drive on fresh seeds.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage2d_`.

21. The walking flies online are trained, not wired; and our rhythm measure was flawed

Slide message: *The walking flies circulating online are driven by trained controllers, not by connectome wiring. The one wiring-based walking rhythm (Pugliese et al. 2025) uses a firing-rate model. Our reimplementation did not test it fairly: our stand-in for neuron size starves the walking command. Checking the result exposed a flaw in our own rhythm measure, now being audited.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/rate_model.py` reimplements Pugliese et al.'s rate model from the paper and its public configuration, batched over parameter draws. `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage2e.py` runs the registered stage 2e.
- **Effect.** Under DNg100 drive, 11 neurons become active; DNg100 itself reaches 6.54 Hz, because size (here synapse count) sets its threshold. Rhythm predictions fail; the lesion prediction passes vacuously. DNb08's "rhythm" (0.7367) is one burst and a plateau. The registered rhythmicity measure has no peak requirement; the registered audit (entry 22) re-examined every stage that used it.
- **Why it matters for the interview.** We publish the flaw ourselves, say which earlier claims it touches, and fix it with a registered audit, not a quiet re-score.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage2e_`.

22. The rhythm-measure audit: one registered pass did not survive

Slide message: *We found a flaw in our own rhythm measure, registered an audit before re-scoring anything, and re-ran every affected stage. One earlier pass (the walking leg's "swing") does not survive. Every other registered outcome stands, and the original numbers reproduce exactly.*

- **What changed.** `kinematics.rhythm` requires a genuine autocorrelation peak; `fictive.phase` and the period measures take a method switch (the registered measure stays the default); `src/neuromps/fly/rhythm_audit.py` re-simulates stages 1d, 2a, 2c, 2d and 2e on their own seeds and measures every trial both ways. Registered in `preregistration/rhythm_measure_audit.json` before any corrected value was computed on stage data.
- **Effect.** The registered measure reproduces every recorded outcome. Under the corrected one, stage 1d's D2 fails (forward walking 0.0956, grooming 0.2374); stage 2d's rhythm cells drop from 5 to 1; DNb08's "rhythm" in stage 2e falls to 0.0. Every other registered outcome is unchanged.

- **Why it matters for the interview.** A worked example of the discipline under pressure: the flaw found by ourselves, the fix registered before use, the earlier claim withdrawn in public.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/rhythm_audit_SIMULATED.json`.

23. The walking command is switched off by the activity it starts

Slide message: *Driven fairly, the walking command neuron starts a wave of activity that grows until it silences the command itself; the whole nerve cord then runs on its own. The published model avoids this by simulating only the front-leg network and capping recruitment at 500 neurons. That is what we test next.*

- **What changed.** `rate_model.drive_input` gives each driven neuron the input that alone brings it to a target rate; `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage2f.py` runs the registered stage 2f (two size rules, corrected rhythm measure, a precondition that the command is on, a lesion test that counts only if a rhythm exists).
- **Effect.** The precondition fails in both size rules (DNg100 0.18 and 0.0 Hz), so the other predictions are uninterpretable. Exploratory trace: DNg100 at 42.67 Hz after 50 ms, silenced by 0.25 s under -4452.5 inhibitory input; 5,247 neurons stay active without it.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage2f_`.

24. The published front-leg network, rebuilt from the male CNS

Slide message: *Rebuilt as published, the male fly's front-leg network does produce a regular motor rhythm, but too few runs found a working input for the registered test to count. The network is nearly all-or-none, so the published input rule overshoots it. A finer input search is next.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage2g.py` builds Pugliese et al.'s front-leg network from the male nerve cord (2,133 neurons) and applies their recruitment rule, with the corrected rhythm measure.
- **Effect.** Precondition failed narrowly (12 and 15 of 32 draws; 16 needed), so the predictions are uninterpretable. Exploratory: in feasible draws, a regular low-rate oscillation in one or two motor-neuron pools (score 0.8747, period 154.0 ms without size scaling), removed by silencing the three-neuron circuit in that size rule only.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage2g_SIMULATED.`.

25. The published walking rhythm, reproduced on the male CNS, with its limits

Slide message: *In our own reimplementation on a different fly's connectome, the walking command drives a front-leg motor rhythm at a walking fly's tempo. Without size scaling it needs the published three-neuron circuit, and not just as a relay. But it still does not alternate antagonist muscles.*

- **What changed.** `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage2h.py`: stage 2g's network with a geometric bisection of the input; `--check` adds the exploratory silencing variants.
- **Effect.** A working input in 32 and 18 of 32 draws; a leg rhythm in both size rules (0.8886 without size scaling, period 196.5 ms), removed by silencing the circuit only without size scaling. Exploratory: keeping the relay and silencing the other two neurons also removes it (0.0483). No reliable promotor-remotor offset, no tibia alternation; the grooming comparison passes vacuously.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage2h_`.

26. The first closed loop: brain-free nerve cord, leg and leg sensors

Slide message: *The simulated nerve cord now moves a leg and feels it move. Feedback from the leg's position sensors shifts the motor neurons toward resisting the movement, as insect reflexes*

do. In a held posture that barely moves the leg, and blind input does the same. A perturbation test is next.

- **What changed.** `body.Session` steps the leg; `model.simulate` takes an `extend` hook; `src/neuromps/fly/closed_loop.py` couples nerve cord and leg every millisecond and drives sensory neurons from a joint angle; `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage3a.py` runs the registered arms; `--check` the exploratory activation-scale check.
- **Effect.** Go/no-go failed: tibia shift 0.0054 rad (0.1 needed); 3 of 5 pass (silence, no resistance from the opposite assignment, the reach survives). Motor level: extensor 43.25 to 31.75 Hz under resistance, matched by the sham.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage3a_`.

27. A push on the leg: the loop does not push back

Slide message: *We pushed the simulated leg and timed its return. The position sensors' feedback did not bring it back faster: the muscles alone set the return. The front leg's sensors are thinly traced in this connectome, about one fifth of the hind leg's. That is the limit to state, and to fix with a better-traced leg.*

- **What changed.** `body.Session.step` accepts joint torques; `closed_loop.Loop` takes a perturbation window; `src/neuromps/fly/embodied_stage3b.py` runs the registered perturbation test; `--check` counts proprioceptors per leg.
- **Effect.** Push flexes the tibia 0.628 rad; return 32.0 ms with resistance feedback against 30.0 open loop (2 of 5 pass; contingency uninterpretable). Left front leg: 4 claw neurons; left hind leg: 22.
- **Evidence.** Roadmap §7 and figure; `outputs/fly/embodied_stage3b_`.

Work queue (decided 2026-10-24, from the post-round-1 review)

Item	Status	Registered before running
Synaptic depression under GABA-A block	done, entry 7 (failed as registered)	yes
ToxCast potency bridge	replaced by entry 6 (only four shared compounds)	—
Output-tract electrode	done, entry 9 (4 of 4 pass; 7 of 10 draws)	yes
Brain and nerve cord as a two-chamber chip (male CNS)	scoped out: one chamber pair is an anecdote, and FlyWire already tested 698 region pairs (§25)	—
Twin posteriors as classifier features	done as a twin-fitted prior, entry 8 (the delta posterior infers one knob, outside Task 1's domain)	yes
Random-graph-to-connectome blend for organoids	dropped	—
Embodied, closed-loop fly (body, nerve cord to muscles, sensory feedback)	roadmap after the final (`report/ROADMAP_EMBODIED_FLY.md`, entry 12); its first step, motor-neuron readouts, is entry 10	—

Why the blend was dropped: grafting fly wiring onto a model of a mammalian cortical culture has no biological basis, and organoid–monolayer differences have many confounds, so a match would prove nothing. The embodied fly is not dropped but scheduled: it adds new information only with the loop closed (nerve cord to muscles, body, sensory feedback), which is a research project for after the final; reading the motor neurons (entry 10) is its first step.